STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-3850
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED **03/31/22**	DATE REVISED	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT ANCILLARY TRAFFIC PROCEDURES	CROSS REFERENCE P-3600 Vehicle Towing Procedures			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the procedures for Ancillary Traffic Direction and Control Procedures.

II. Policy:

It is the policy of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office to utilize manual traffic control to ensure an orderly flow of traffic with the safety of all motorists, pedestrians, and public safety personnel in mind. Incidents in which manual traffic control may be used include crash scenes, fire scenes, hazardous situations on or near the roadway, special law enforcement operations, or special events.

III. Procedures:

A. Traffic and Control:

1. When arriving on scene, deputies shall assess the area, park the cruiser in a highly visible spot where it will not add to the congestion, and activate their overhead lights and traffic arrow.

2. Deputies shall wear a reflective traffic vest or ANSI class 3 jacket/coat when directing traffic.

3. If additional manpower is needed to establish appropriate traffic control, the deputy shall make a request via Communications, and advise the responding units where they are needed.

4. Traffic cones, temporary signs, and/or barricades may be used when necessary.

5. Deputies shall utilize clear and easily understood and uniform hand signals when directing traffic. Traffic shall be stopped in all directions before allowing/changing traffic flow in another direction.

6. Deputies shall ensure the safety of rescue, fire and law enforcement personnel that are working a scene.

7. If an entire roadway needs to be closed, there should be adequate warning to motorists in advance of the closing to avoid further traffic congestion.

8. Alternate routes shall be selected with roadway capacity and safety in mind. Alternate routes from main thoroughfares through residential and school areas should be avoided whenever possible.

B. **Fire/Critical Incident Scene Procedures:** At fire scenes or critical incidents, deputies shall park their patrol units at a safe distance from the scene, keeping in mind the accessibility for ingress and egress of fire, rescue, and other emergency vehicles. Alternate routes for motor vehicle traffic shall be determined, and traffic diverted to those routes.

C. **Adverse Weather Procedures:** When adverse weather conditions occur causing hazardous driving conditions, the deputy shall evaluate the situation and arrange appropriate traffic control or maintenance. The deputy shall advise Communications of what type of maintenance the situation requires, i.e., sand, salt, plowing, etc.

D. **Road Closings:** In instances of road closings due to flooding, trees down across the roadway, etc. the responsible local, county or state agency shall be notified, and barricades/temporary signs requested.

E. **Traffic Control Signals:** Deputies will only manually operate traffic control signals with Command Staff approval. This is most often done to hasten the departure of large numbers of persons from large gatherings.

F. **Correcting Hazardous Roadway Conditions:**

1. When a deputy becomes aware of an existing or potential roadway hazard, the deputy is responsible for taking action to control traffic and arrange for the correction of the hazard.

a) If the hazard is in the form of debris or an abandoned vehicle(s), the deputy shall arrange for its prompt removal.

b) When the hazard is in the form of a roadway defect or malfunctioning, missing, or downed traffic control devices, the deputy shall notify Communications and request that the appropriate agency respond and

repair or correct the problem. The hazard may require that the deputy remain at the scene until the hazard is corrected or removed.

G. Motorist Assistance:

1. All on-duty road patrol deputies, when practical, shall provide assistance to motorists.

2. When a stranded motorist is observed on or along the roadway, the deputy shall stop, notify Communications of the location, license plate number, etc., and offer assistance.

3. When the deputy cannot stop, they shall notify Communications of the location and the vehicle description, so that another deputy can be dispatched to assist.

4. Mechanical Assistance: Deputies are authorized to assist motorists with mechanical breakdowns (e.g., flat tires) if they are knowledgeable in the needed assistance.

5. If a stranded vehicle is in a hazardous location, the deputy shall stand by with the patrol unit's emergency lights on to warn oncoming traffic. The deputy shall assess the situation to determine the best course of action.

6. In the event that a person is in need of medical or fire assistance, the deputy shall have Communications dispatch the appropriate units. The deputy shall provide practical assistance until the proper service arrives.

7. During adverse weather conditions, deputies shall make an effort to transport or arrange for the transportation of stranded persons to a place of safety.

8. When the motorist requires towing service, the deputy shall follow (SOP P-3600 Vehicle Towing Procedures).

9. When traveling through another jurisdiction, a deputy may stop and assist a motorist if an apparent emergency or other hazardous condition exists. Otherwise, a local law enforcement agency will be contacted by telephone or radio to assist the motorist.

H. Vehicular Escorts

1. Non-emergency Escorts:

a) There may be times or circumstance when the Sheriff's Office is requested to conduct escorts. Such escorts may include:

(1) Funerals.

(2) Oversize vehicles.
(3) Vehicles with hazardous or unusual cargo.
(4) Motorcades of dignitaries.

b) Such requests shall be forwarded to the Road Patrol Commander or designee for approval on a per case basis.

2. Emergencies:

a) Deputies shall not provide escort services for private vehicles.

b) If a deputy encounters a citizen en route to a hospital with a life-threatening medical emergency, the deputy shall assist the victim by calling for rescue personnel.